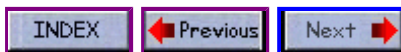


# C Programming



## THE CONDITIONAL EXPRESSION OPERATOR

This conditional expression operator takes THREE operators. The two symbols used to denote this operator are the ? and the :. The first operand is placed before the ?, the second operand between the ? and the :, and the third after the :. The general format is,

```
condition ? expression1 : expression2
```

If the result of condition is TRUE ( non-zero ), expression1 is evaluated and the result of the evaluation becomes the result of the operation. If the condition is FALSE (zero), then expression2 is evaluated and its result becomes the result of the operation. An example will help,

```
s = ( x < 0 ) ? -1 : x * x;
```

```
If x is less than zero then s = -1
```

```
If x is greater than zero then s = x * x
```

## Example program illustrating conditional expression operator

```
#include <stdio.h>

main()
{
    int input;

    printf("I will tell you if the number is positive, negative or ze
    printf("please enter your number now--->");
    scanf("%d", &input );
    (input < 0) ? printf("negative\n") : ((input > 0) ? printf("posit
}
```

### Sample Program Output

```
I will tell you if the number is positive, negative or zero!
please enter your number now---> 32
positive
```

## CLASS EXERCISE C12

Evaluate the following expression, where a=4, b=5

```
least_value = ( a < b ) ? a : b;
```

## [Answers](#)

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